

HOW YOU TEST IN A RETAIL STORE

When it comes to TVs, the showroom demos given by sellers can be highly deceiving. Here are some tests that you can perform while at the store to get the real picture.



1 Carry your own content (movie clips with fast action scenes, sports clips, movie clips with dark scenes, etc) in a pen drive to test the TV performance. Carry multiple pen drives with the same content (if possible) to be able to check and compare performance between two TVs at the same time.



2 Ensure you keep all settings to default or 50% (in case of contrast and brightness levels) and turn off all extras (motion control, dynamic contrast, dynamic depth, etc.)



3 Play each type of content and check the performance in terms of how the TV handles fast/action based scenes, dark scenes and overall color reproduction. Do not compare TV performance on basis of the looping demo clips that are played on TVs.



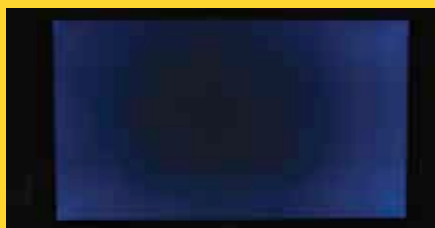
4 Ensure you switch to regular SD channels to check how the TV handles regular standard definition content. The image processing and upscaling engines can make a big difference to the quality of regular TV content.



5 Evaluate the viewing angles, check for color shifts and loss in color fidelity as you pan from left to right.



6 Try the interface and smart capabilities by actually syncing your phone with the TV, beam content to the TV and check for speeds, frame drops, lags etc.



7 Detect backlight bleeding and unevenly lit panels by carefully looking at the edges of the screen when playing a dark scene, any kind of glow or uneven lighting at the edges denote backlight bleeding and isn't preferable. Similarly many TVs suffer from uneven panel lighting. Look for patches or dark spots by setting the TV to display solid colors, especially whites. You can do this by taking solid color image files (jpegs) most TVs with USB slots should be able to play them as photos/images.

Unfortunately, higher costs and the bulkier nature of these panels has led to very few manufacturers offering such TVs. Most LED TVs sold by grade A manufacturers (Samsung, Sony, LG, Panasonic, Tohiba, Sharp, Hitachi, etc) are edge-lit LED TVs, the expensive models offer local dimming while the budget models usually don't. The type of LED panel used in a TV is

rarely mentioned as a part of the marketing materials/activities. You'll have to dig into the full lists of specifications to get the information.

Panel type:

IPS and VA are the two most common panel types used in LED TVs, IPS panels (used by LG and Panasonic) offer better

quality colors in terms of being more natural, better depth and excellent viewing angles. VA panels (commonly used by Samsung and Sony) offer slightly better contrast and punchier/vivid colors than IPS panels. Though VA panels are known to suffer from color shift and input lag issues. Given the various grades of panels for both panel types, the real quality dif-